

Math 81: Abstract Algebra

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Credit Statement: Talked to Sair Shaikh and Stack Overflow.

Problem 2. Let p be an odd prime number, $\zeta = \zeta_p$, and $K = \mathbb{Q}(\zeta)$. We know that $K/\mathbb{Q}$ is a Galois extension with (cyclic) group $G \cong (\mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z})^\times$ and let $\sigma \in G$ be a generator. Let $H \subset G$ be the unique subgroup of index 2. Define

$$\eta_0 = \sum_{\tau \in H} \tau(\zeta), \quad \eta_1 = \sum_{\tau \in G \setminus H} \tau(\zeta).$$

These are called the periods of ζ with respect to H .

(a) Prove that $\sigma(\eta_0) = \eta_1$ and $\sigma(\eta_1) = \eta_0$ and that

$$\eta_0 = \sum_{a \text{ square}} \zeta^a, \quad \eta_1 = \sum_{a \text{ nonsquare}} \zeta^a,$$

where the sums are taken over the set of squares and nonsquares, respectively, in $(\mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z})^\times$.

(b) Prove that $\eta_0 + \eta_1 = -1$, and more generally, that

$$\sum_{\tau \in G} \tau(\zeta^a) = -1$$

for any a with $p \nmid a$.

(c) Let

$$g = \sum_{i=0}^{p-1} \zeta^{i^2}$$

be the classical Gauss sum. Prove that

$$g = \sum_{i=0}^{p-2} (-1)^i \sigma^i(\zeta) = \eta_0 - \eta_1.$$

(d) Prove that $\tau(g) = g$ if $\tau \in H$ and $\tau(g) = -g$ if $\tau \in G \setminus H$. Conclude, using the Galois correspondence, that $[\mathbb{Q}(g) : \mathbb{Q}] = 2$. Also conclude that $\overline{g} = g$ if -1 is a square modulo p and that $\overline{g} = -g$ if -1 is not a square modulo p , where the overline is complex conjugation. Hint. For the last part, recall that inversion is the same as complex conjugation for any root of unity.

(e) Prove that $g\bar{g} = p$. Hint. Transform $g\bar{g}$ to the double sum

$$\sum_{k=0}^{p-2} (-1)^k \sum_{j=0}^{p-2} \sigma^j \left(\frac{\sigma^k(\zeta)}{\zeta} \right),$$

then use part (b).

(f) Prove that $g^2 = (-1)^{(p-1)/2} p$.

(g) Finally, conclude that

$$\mathbb{Q} \left(\sqrt{(-1)^{(p-1)/2} p} \right)$$

is the unique quadratic subfield of $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta_p)/\mathbb{Q}$.

Solution.

Note that we know that the set of non-zero squares form an index two subgroup of $\mathbb{F}_p^\times$ (from HW2, Problem 1.5), and $(\mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z})^\times \cong \mathbb{F}_p^\times$. Hence H must be isomorphic to this subgroup.

(a) Let σ be a generator for G . Since H is the subgroup formed by non-zero squares in G , it's elements are of the form σ^{2n} , where $n \in \{1, \dots, \frac{p-1}{2}\}$, that is they are even powers of σ . So, $\forall \tau \in H$, $\sigma\tau = \sigma^{2n+1} \notin H$. Hence,

$$\sigma(\eta_0) = \sum_{\tau \in H} \sigma(\tau(\zeta)) = \sum_{\tau \in G \setminus H} \tau(\zeta) = \eta_1$$

And similarly, any element τ in $G \setminus H$ is an odd powers of σ . Then $\sigma\tau$ is an even power (odd + 1). Hence, $\sigma\tau \in H$,

$$\sigma(\eta_1) = \sum_{\tau \in G \setminus H} \sigma(\tau(\zeta)) = \sum_{\tau \in H} \tau(\zeta) = \eta_0$$

Moreover since $G \cong (\mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z})^\times$, each $\tau \in G$ corresponds to some $a \in (\mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z})^\times$. Since σ is a generator, let $\tau = \sigma_a$ and we have $\tau(\zeta) = \zeta^a$. And as we already said H has squares, and $G \setminus H$ doesn't. Hence,

$$\eta_0 = \sum_{a \text{ square}} \zeta^a, \quad \eta_1 = \sum_{a \text{ nonsquare}} \zeta^a,$$

(b) Note that if $p \nmid a$ then ζ^a is not 1. Then,

$$\sum_{\tau \in G} \tau(\zeta^a) = \sum_{b \in (\mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z})^\times} (\zeta^a)^b = \sum_{b \in \{1, \dots, p-1\}} \zeta^{ab}$$

Since $p \nmid a$, multiplication by a is a bijection on $(\mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z})^\times$. That is as b ranges over $\{1, \dots, p-1\}$ so does $ab \pmod{p}$. Hence we can write,

$$\sum_{\tau \in G} \tau(\zeta^a) = \sum_{b \in \{1, \dots, p-1\}} \zeta^{ab} = \sum_{c=1}^{p-1} \zeta^c = \zeta \frac{\zeta^{p-1} - 1}{\zeta - 1} = \frac{1 - \zeta}{\zeta - 1} = -1$$

Moreover $\eta_0 + \eta_1 = -1$, when $a = 1$ (because they iterate over H and $G \setminus H$, and hence all of G).

- (c) (i) Let $g = \sum_{i=0}^{p-1} \zeta^{i^2}$. Note that as i cycles through $\{1, \dots, p-1\}$, i^2 cycles through every square in that range twice. Hence,

$$\begin{aligned} g &= \sum_{i=0}^{p-1} \zeta^{i^2} \\ &= \zeta^{0^2} + 2 \sum_{\substack{a \text{ square} \\ a \in \{1, \dots, p-1\}}} \zeta^a \\ &= 1 + 2\eta_0 \end{aligned}$$

From part (b) we know $\eta_0 + \eta_1 = -1$, that is $-(\eta_0 + \eta_1) = 1$.

$$g = 1 + 2\eta_0 = -\eta_0 - \eta_1 + 2\eta_0 = \eta_0 - \eta_1$$

- (ii) From part (a) we know that η_0 is the sum of elements in G that are even powers of the generator σ applied to ζ , and η_1 is the sum of elements in G that are odd powers of the generator σ applied to ζ . That is,

- Even Powers: $\sigma^0, \sigma^2, \dots, \sigma^{p-3}$, so $i = 0, 2, \dots, (p-3)/2$.
- Odd Powers: $\sigma^1, \sigma^3, \dots, \sigma^{p-2}$, so $i = 1, 3, \dots, (p-1)/2$.

So we can write,

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{i=0}^{(p-3)/2} (-1)^{2i} \sigma^{2i}(\zeta) + \sum_{i=1}^{(p-1)/2} (-1)^{2i-1} \sigma^{2i-1}(\zeta) &= \sum_{i=0}^{(p-3)/2} \sigma^{2i}(\zeta) - \sum_{i=1}^{(p-1)/2} \sigma^{2i-1}(\zeta) \\ &= \sum_{\tau \in H} \tau(\zeta) - \sum_{\tau \in G \setminus H} \tau(\zeta) \\ &= \eta_0 - \eta_1 = g \end{aligned}$$

Hence,

$$g = \sum_{i=0}^{p-2} (-1)^i \sigma^i(\zeta) = \eta_0 - \eta_1.$$

(d) (i) $\tau(g)$, for $\tau \in H$ is

$$\tau(g) = \tau(\eta_0) - \tau(\eta_1)$$

But since τ is an even power of σ , say $\tau = \sigma^{2k}$. We know from part (a) that

$$\sigma(\sigma(\eta_0)) = \sigma(\eta_1) = \eta_0 \quad \sigma(\sigma(\eta_1)) = \sigma(\eta_0) = \eta_1$$

Thus σ^2 fixes both η_0 and η_1 , and therefore any even power σ^{2k} also fixes them. So,

$$\tau(g) = \eta_0 - \eta_1$$

Similarly, $\tau(g)$, for $\tau \in G \setminus H$ is

$$\tau(g) = \tau(\eta_0) - \tau(\eta_1)$$

Then τ is an odd power of σ , say $\tau = \sigma^{2k+1}$ we know from part (a) that

$$\sigma(\eta_0) = \eta_1 \quad \sigma(\eta_1) = \eta_0$$

Since σ swaps η_0 and η_1 and σ^{2k} fixes them, σ^{2k+1} also swaps them. So,

$$\tau(g) = \eta_1 - \eta_0$$

(ii) That is, g is fixed by an index 2 subgroup of G , i.e. H , and thus by Galois correspondence is a degree two extension of $\mathbb{Q}$. That is,

$$[\mathbb{Q}(g) : \mathbb{Q}] = [G : H] = 2$$

(iii) Note that complex conjugation sends ζ to ζ^{-1} . Thus complex conjugation is the automorphism $\sigma_{-1} \in G$, where

$$\sigma_{-1}(\zeta) = \zeta^{-1}.$$

Hence $\bar{g} = \sigma_{-1}(g)$.

If -1 is a square modulo p , then $a = -1 \in (\mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z})^\times$ is a square, i.e. $\sigma_a \in H$, and by part (i), $\sigma_a(g) = g$.

If -1 is not a square modulo p , then $a = -1 \in (\mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z})^\times$ is not a square, i.e. $\sigma_a \in G \setminus H$, and by part (i), $\sigma_a(g) = -g$.

(e) Note that complex conjugation sends $\sigma_i \rightarrow \sigma_{-i}$. So we have,

$$\begin{aligned} g\bar{g} &= \left(\sum_{i=0}^{p-2} (-1)^i \sigma^i(\zeta) \right) \left(\sum_{j=0}^{p-2} (-1)^{-j} \sigma^{-j}(\zeta) \right) \\ &= \sum_{i=0}^{p-2} \sum_{j=0}^{p-2} (-1)^i (-1)^{-j} \sigma^i(\zeta) \sigma^{-j}(\zeta) \\ &= \sum_{i=0}^{p-2} \sum_{j=0}^{p-2} (-1)^{i-j} \sigma^{i-j}(\zeta) \end{aligned}$$

Let $k = i - j \pmod{p}$, and note that $\sigma^k(\zeta) = \sigma^j(\sigma^k(\zeta))\sigma^{-j}(\zeta) = \sigma^j\left(\frac{\sigma^k(\zeta)}{\zeta}\right)$. So,

$$\begin{aligned} g\bar{g} &= \sum_{i=0}^{p-2} \sum_{j=0}^{p-2} (-1)^k \sigma^k(\zeta) \\ &= \sum_{k=0}^{p-2} (-1)^k \sum_{j=0}^{p-2} \sigma^j\left(\frac{\sigma^k(\zeta)}{\zeta}\right) \end{aligned}$$

If σ corresponds to $\alpha \in (\mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z})^\times$, we have

$$g\bar{g} = \sum_{k=0}^{p-2} (-1)^k \sum_{j=0}^{p-2} \sigma^j(\zeta^{\alpha^k-1})$$

Note that if $k = 0$, then $\zeta^{\alpha^k-1} = 1$, and the inner sum evaluates to $p - 1$ otherwise from part (b), the inner sum would evaluate to -1

$$\begin{aligned} g\bar{g} &= \sum_{k=0}^{p-2} (-1)^k \sum_{j=0}^{p-2} \sigma^j(\zeta^{\alpha^k-1}) \\ &= \sum_{k=0}^{p-2} (-1)^k \sum_{j=0}^{p-2} \sigma^j(\zeta^{\alpha^k-1}) + \sum_{k=1}^{p-2} (-1)^k \sum_{j=0}^{p-2} \sigma^j(\zeta^{\alpha^k-1}) \\ &= (p-1) + \sum_{k=1}^{p-2} (-1)^k (-1) \\ &= (p-1) + (-1)(-1) \\ &= p \end{aligned}$$

Hence proved.

- (f) From part (d) we know that $\bar{g} = g$ if -1 is a square modulo p , and $\bar{g} = -g$ otherwise. Recall from Math 71 that -1 is a square modulo p iff $p - 1 \equiv 0 \pmod{4}$, that is $p - 1$ is divisible by 2 twice, and $(p - 1)/2$ is even (otherwise it's odd). Hence,

$$g^2 = (-1)^{(p-1)/2} p$$

- (g) Note, $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{(-1)^{(p-1)/2}p}) = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{g^2}) = \mathbb{Q}(g)$. From part (a) we know that $[\mathbb{Q}(g) : \mathbb{Q}] = 2$ and since H is the unique index two subgroup of the galois group G , it fixes this field. Hence, $[\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{(-1)^{(p-1)/2}p}) : \mathbb{Q}] = 2$.

Problem 3. Fundamental Theorem of Algebra.

An ordered field is a field F together with a subset F^+ of positive elements satisfying: $a, b \in F^+ \Rightarrow a + b \in F^+$ and $ab \in F^+$ and for each $a \in F$ exactly one of $a \in F^+$, $a = 0$, or $-a \in F^+$ is true.

- (a) Prove that if F is an ordered field then any nonzero square is positive, that -1 is not positive, and that F has characteristic zero. Also, prove that $F(i) = F[x]/(x^2 + 1)$ is not an ordered field. **Challenge:** Prove that a field F can be ordered if and only if -1 is not a sum of squares.
- (b) An ordered field F is called real closed if every positive element has a square root and every polynomial of odd degree over F has a root. Prove that $\mathbb{R}$ and $\mathbb{R} \cap \overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ are real closed. **Hint:** You may need a tiny bit of analysis, but try to keep it to a minimum.
- (c) Prove that a real closed field does not have any nontrivial finite extensions of odd degree.
- (d) Prove that if F is real closed then the only quadratic extension of F is $F(i)$, and every element of $F(i)$ has a square root.
- (e) Prove that a field K is algebraically closed if and only if it does not admit any nontrivial algebraic extensions if and only if it does not admit any nontrivial finite extension.
- (f) Prove that if F is a real closed field then $F(i)$ is algebraically closed.

Hint: First, let $L'/F(i)$ be a finite extension and L/F the normal closure of L'/F . Then why is L/F a Galois extension whose group G has even order? Let $H \subset G$ be a Sylow 2-subgroup. Use the Galois correspondence with $H \subset G$ to prove that G is actually a 2-group. Remember the result from abstract algebra that every finite p -group has a subgroup of index p , and use this, with the Galois correspondence, to prove that actually G must be trivial.

- (g) Deduce that $\mathbb{C}$ and $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ are algebraically closed.

Solution.

- (a) Let F be an ordered field. Then,

- (i) Any non-zero square is positive.

Let a be a non-zero element in F . If $a \in F^+$, then $a^2 = a \cdot a \in F^+$.

If $-a \in F^+$, then $(-a)^2 = (-a) \cdot (-a) \in F^+$. We want to show that $(-a)^2 = a^2$. Since, $-a = -1 \cdot a$, this is equivalent to showing that $-1^2 = 1$ in F .

Now note that,

$$(-1)(-1) + (-1)1 = (-1)(-1 + 1) = 0$$

But that also implies,

$$(-1)(-1) = -(-1) = 1$$

Hence, proved.

(ii) -1 is not positive.

We will show this by contradiction. Let $p \neq -1$, $p \in F^+$. For the sake of contradiction, assume $(-1) \in F^+$. Then since for any $a, b \in F^+$, $ab \in F^+$, $p(-1) = -p \in F^+$. However, by definition of an ordered field, both $-p$ and p can't be in F^+ . Hence a contradiction, and -1 cannot be positive.

(iii) F has characteristic 0.

The characteristic of a field F is defined as the smallest positive integer n such that $1 + 1 + \cdots + 1 = 0$ (n times) in F . From part (ii), we know that $-(-1) = 1 \in F^+$, $0 \notin F^+$, and we know that for any $a, b \in F^+$, $a + b \in F^+$. So, $1 + \cdots + 1$ (n times), for any n cannot equal 0. Hence, such an integer doesn't exist and F must be characteristic 0.

(iv) $F(i) = F[x]/(x^2 + 1)$ is not an ordered field.

We will show this by contradiction. Assume $F(i)$ is an ordered field. Then for any $a \in F(i)$, exactly one of $a \in F^+$, $-a \in F^+$, $a = 0$. Then in $F(i)$, $i^2 + 1 = 0 \implies i^2 = -1$, but from part (i) we know that non-zero squares are positive, and from part (ii) we know that -1 is not positive. So, i must be 0, but we also know $(0 \cdot 0 = 0(0 + 0) = 0 \cdot 0 + 0 \cdot 0 \implies 0 \cdot 0 = 0 \cdot 0 - 0 \cdot 0 = 0)$ that $0^2 = 0$. Hence, $i \notin F^+$, $-i \notin F^+$, $i \neq 0$, which is a contradiction, and $F(i)$ cannot be an ordered field.

(v) F can be ordered if and only if -1 is not a sum of squares.

($\implies$) Assume F is ordered.

Let $a, b \in F$. Then, from part (i) we know that $a^2, b^2 \in F^+$, that is $a^2 + b^2 \in F^+$. But since $-1 \notin F^+$, it cannot be the sum of squares.

($\impliedby$) Assume -1 is not a sum of squares in F .

Definition: A field is called a real field if -1 is not a sum of two squares in the field.

Definition: A field is real closed if it is real and has no proper, real extensions.

Claim: Every real field has a real closure.

Proof: Let F be a real field, K_i/F , for $i \in$ the indexing set I , be algebraic extensions of F . Then, we define the set $K = \{K_i : K_i/F \text{ real algebraic extensions of } F\}$. Then we want to find M such that $\forall K_i \in K, K_i \subseteq M$. Let L be such that,

$$L = \bigcup_{K_i \in K} K_i$$

By Zorn's Lemma, if at least one K_i is non-empty, and every constituent chain $C \subseteq L$ has an upperbound this limit exists.

- i. L is not empty since F/F is a real algebraic extension of F .
- ii. Every constituent chain $C \subseteq L$ has an upperbound.

Let $K' = \bigcup_{K_i \in C} K_i \in C$ be this upper bound. We show that K' is a real field.

- Closed under Inverses:

If $a \in K'$ then there exists some $K_i \in C$ such that $a \in K_i$. Since K_i is a field, both the additive $-a$ and multiplicative inverse a^{-1} of a is in K_i and hence in K' .

- Closed under Addition:

$\forall a, b \in K'$, then there exist $K_i, K_j \in C$ such that $a \in K_i, b \in K_j$. Since C is totally ordered, either $K_i \subseteq K_j$ or $K_j \subseteq K_i$. Without loss of generality, assume $K_i \subseteq K_j$, then $a \in K_j$, and since K_j is a field, it is closed under addition, and there exist a $c \in K_j \subseteq K'$ such that $a + b = c$. Hence K' is closed under addition.

- Closed under Multiplication:

Similarly, $\forall a, b \in K'$, then there exist $K_i, K_j \in C$ such that $a \in K_i, b \in K_j$. Since C is totally ordered, either $K_i \subseteq K_j$ or $K_j \subseteq K_i$. Without loss of generality, assume $K_i \subseteq K_j$, then $a \in K_j$, and since K_j is a field, it is closed under multiplication, and there exist a $c \in K_j \subseteq K'$ such that $a \cdot b = c$. Hence K' is closed under multiplication.

- Distributivity, Commutativity, and Associativity also work similarly.

- -1 is not a sum of two squares:

For the sake of contradiction assume it is. Then there exist some $a, b \in K'$ such that $a^2 + b^2 = -1$. Thus, there exist $K_i, K_j \in C$ such that $a \in K_i, b \in K_j$. Since C is totally ordered, either $K_i \subseteq K_j$ or $K_j \subseteq K_i$. Without loss of generality, assume $K_i \subseteq K_j$, then $a \in K_j$. Then $a^2 + b^2$ should sum to -1 , but K_j is real, a contradiction. Hence, K' must be real.

Hence, K' is a real field, and L exists. Thus, every field has a real closure.

Claim: A real closed field is ordered.

Proof: Let F be a real closed field. Then F has no real, proper, algebraic extensions. In particular, for every $a \in F$, exactly one of the polynomials

$$f(x) = x^2 - a, \quad g(x) = x^2 + a$$

has a root in F .

Since F is real, -1 cannot be written as a sum of squares. Hence $x^2 + 1$ has no root in F , so $\sqrt{-1} \notin F$. It follows that for every $a \neq 0$, either a is a square in F or $-a$ is a square in F . Now, we can establish an ordering for F .

Let F^+ be the set,

$$F^+ = \{a : \sqrt{a} \in F\}$$

i. F^+ is closed under addition.

$\forall a, b \in F^+$, then both a, b are squares and $a + b$ satisfies the polynomial $f(x) = x^2 - (a + b)$. Since F has no real, proper, algebraic extensions $\sqrt{a + b}$ must be in F and hence $a + b \in F^+$.

ii. F^+ is closed under multiplication.

$\forall a, b \in F^+$ if $a = x^2$, $b = y^2$ then $a \cdot b = x^2 \cdot y^2 = (xy)^2$. Hence, $ab \in F^+$.

iii. For all $a \in F$ either $a = 0$ or $a \in F^+$ or $-a \in F^+$.

From what we said earlier, if $a \in F^+$ then $-a \notin F^+$. Otherwise both a and $-a$ would be squares, so

$$-1 = \frac{-a}{a}$$

would be a square in F , implying $\sqrt{-1} \in F$, contradicting that F is real.

And, if $a \notin F^+$ then a is not a square. By the property established earlier, this implies $-a$ is a square, hence $-a \in F^+$.

Hence F^+ forms the positive subset of F and defines an ordering on F .

Claim: All real fields are ordered.

Proof: Let F be a real field, and $\bar{F}$ be its real closure. From the claim above we know that $\bar{F}$ is ordered, i.e., there exists a positive subset $\bar{F}^+ \subset \bar{F}$. Then, consider the subset $F^+ = F \cap \bar{F}^+$. We claim that this is the positive subset that defines an order on F .

i. F^+ is closed under addition.

If $a, b \in F^+$ then $a, b \in \bar{F}^+$. And since $\bar{F}^+$ is closed under addition $a + b \in \bar{F}^+$. But because F is a field, $a + b \in F$. Hence $a + b \in F \cap \bar{F}^+$. Since a, b were arbitrary this works for all $a, b \in F^+$.

ii. F^+ is closed under multiplication.

Similarly, if $a, b \in F^+$ then $a, b \in \bar{F}^+$. And since $\bar{F}^+$ is closed under multiplication $ab \in \bar{F}^+$. But because F is a field, $ab \in F$. Hence $ab \in F \cap \bar{F}^+$. Since a, b were arbitrary this works for all $a, b \in F^+$.

iii. For all $a \in F$ either $a = 0$ or $a \in F^+$ or $-a \in F^+$.

Since $\bar{F}$ is ordered, for any $a \in F^+$, $a \neq 0$, $\bar{F}^+$ only contains one of a and $-a$. Hence, so does F^+ .

Thus, F^+ forms the positive subset of F and defines an ordering on F . Hence, all real fields are ordered.

Thus, a field F can be ordered if and only if -1 is not a sum of squares.

(b) (i) $\mathbb{R}$ is real-closed.

Let $a \in \mathbb{R}^+$. Finding the squareroot of a is equivalent to solving the quadratic polynomial $f(x) = x^2 - a$ over $\mathbb{R}$. Now, note that at $x = 0$, $f(x) = -a < 0$ and when $x > a$ then $f(x) > a > 0$. Then, by the intermediate value theorem there must exist some x such that $f(x) = 0$. Hence, every positive real number has a square root.

Let $f(x) \in \mathbb{R}$ be a monic polynomial of degree n , where n is odd. Then as $x \rightarrow \infty$, $f(x) \rightarrow \infty$ and as $x \rightarrow -\infty$, $f(x) \rightarrow -\infty$. So there exist some a, b such that $f(a) < 0 < f(b)$. Then by the intermediate value theorem there must exist some c such that $f(c) = 0$. Hence every odd degree polynomial has at least one real root.

Also note that over $\mathbb{C}$ non-real roots come in pairs. Since $f(x) \in \mathbb{R}$, complex conjugation fixes all coefficients of f . So if α is a root of $f(x)$, the complex conjugate of $f(\alpha)$ is $\overline{f(\alpha)} = f(\overline{\alpha}) = 0$. Hence, $\overline{\alpha}$ is also a root. That is, complex roots come in pairs.

(ii) $\mathbb{R} \cap \overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ is real-closed.

Recall that $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ is the algebraic closure of $\mathbb{Q}$. So, $\overline{\mathbb{Q}} \cap \mathbb{R}$ is the real part of the algebraic closure of the rationals. For convenience, let $K = \overline{\mathbb{Q}} \cap \mathbb{R}$.

Let $a \in K^+$. From part (i) we know that all positive real numbers have square roots, that is $\sqrt{a} \in \mathbb{R}$. So, it suffices to show that the squareroots is contained in $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$. Since $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ is the algebraic closure of $\mathbb{Q}$ and our subfield contains all real algebraic roots to polynomials over $\mathbb{Q}$, a must satisfy some polynomial $f(x)$ over $\mathbb{Q}$. Then note that $\sqrt{a}$ satisfies $f(x^2)$. Hence $\sqrt{a}$ is algebraic and must be in the field.

Let $f(x) \in K[x]$ be a polynomial of odd degree n . Note that if we consider $f(x) \in \overline{\mathbb{Q}}$, then all roots of $f(x)$ are in $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$. Since K is a restriction of $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ to the reals, and complex roots come in pairs, K at least has one root that satisfies $f(x)$. Hence every odd degree polynomial has a root.

(c) Let F be a real-closed field, and K/F a finite extension. We know that finite extensions are generated by a finite number of algebraic elements over the base field. Let K/F be

generated by m elements. Then there exists a tower,

$$\begin{array}{c}
K = F(\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_{m-1})(\alpha_m) \\
\uparrow \\
K = F(\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_{m-2})(\alpha_{m-1}) \\
\uparrow \\
\vdots \\
\uparrow \\
F(\alpha_1) \\
\uparrow \\
F
\end{array}$$

Let $f_i(x) = m_{\alpha_i/F(\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_{i-1})}(x)$ be the minimal polynomial of degree n_i of such an algebraic element. Note that n_i is either 1 (trivial extension) or even because from part (ii) we know that polynomials of odd degree have a root over the base field, that is if n_i is odd then $f_i(x)$ is not irreducible and hence not the minimal polynomial. Also since the degree of the minimal polynomial is the degree of the extension, and each $f_i(x)$ has even degree, and by tower law $[K : F] = \prod_{i=1}^m n_i$ which is a product of even numbers and hence even. Hence, F has no nontrivial finite extensions of odd degree.

- (d) Let F be real-closed. Let K/F be a quadratic extension. We know that K is generated by an element that satisfies a quadratic minimal polynomial $f(x) \in F[x]$. But by definition, all positive elements have a square root in F . So, $f(x)$ must be satisfied by the squareroot of a negative element in F . But since F is a field, we know that -1 exists, and any negative element $a \in F$ (that is $-a \in F^+$) can be written as $a = -1 \cdot -a$. Since $\sqrt{-a} \in F$, adjoining the squareroot of a is equivalent to adjoining $\sqrt{-1}$. Hence, every quadratic extension of F is $F(i)$, where $i = \sqrt{-1}$.

Let $(a + bi)$ be an arbitrary element in $F(i)$, where $a, b \in F$. If $b = 0$ then $\sqrt{(a + bi)} = \sqrt{a} \in F$. If $b \neq 0$, we want to determine if there exist $c, d \in F(i)$ such that $(c + di)^2 = (a + bi)$.

On expanding we get,

$$c^2 - d^2 = a, \quad 2cd = b$$

Now, note that $(c^2 + d^2)^2 = (c^2 - d^2)^2 + (2cd)^2 = a^2 + b^2$. And, $c^2 + d^2 = \sqrt{a^2 + b^2} \in F$ since F is real-closed. Combining this with $c^2 - d^2 = a$ gives us,

$$c^2 = \frac{\sqrt{a^2 + b^2} + a}{2}, \quad d^2 = \frac{\sqrt{a^2 + b^2} - a}{2}$$

which are both positive since $\sqrt{a^2 + b^2} \geq \sqrt{a^2} \geq |a| > 0$. Hence, their square-roots exist in F , and we found are desired squareroot.

- (e) Let $A : K$ is algebraically closed, $B : K$ doesn't admit any non-trivial algebraic extensions, $C : K$ does not admit any non-trivial finite extension.

$A \implies B$

Assume K is algebraically closed. Then any polynomial with coefficients in K has roots in K . That is, there are no non-trivial algebraic extensions.

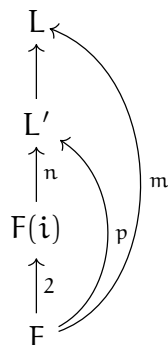
$B \implies C$

Assume K doesn't admit any non-trivial algebraic extensions. We know that all finite extensions are algebraic. Then, since K doesn't admit any non-trivial algebraic extensions, it doesn't admit any non-trivial finite extensions.

$C \implies A$

Assume K doesn't admit any non-trivial finite extensions. For the sake of contradiction, assume K is not algebraically closed. Then there exists at least one polynomial $f(x) \in K[x]$, such that $\alpha \notin K$ is a root. Then $K(\alpha)/K$ is a simple finite extension. But K doesn't admit any non-trivial finite extensions, so $K(\alpha)$ must be a trivial extension, i.e., $\alpha \in K$. A contradiction! Hence, K is algebraically closed.

- (f) Let F be a real closed field and $F(i) = F(\sqrt{-1})$. Now let $L'/F(i)$ be a finite extension, and L/F be the normal closure of L'/F .



Since F is characteristic 0, all of its extensions must be characteristic 0, and hence all polynomials over L are separable. And since normal closures are algebraic, we know that L/F is a normal, separable, and algebraic extension and hence is Galois. Let $G = \text{Gal}(L/F)$. Note that from part (c) we know that $[L : F] = m$ is even and hence $|G|$ is even. Then we claim that G is a 2-group.

Proof: Assume for the sake of contradiction that G is not a 2-group. Let $|G| = m = 2^x \cdot y_1 \cdots y_n$, where $y_1, \dots, y_n$ are odd primes. Then by Sylow's Theorems, we know that there exist subgroups of order $y_1, \dots, y_n$ in G . Then by Galois correspondence, there exist subextensions of F of degrees $y_1, \dots, y_n$, but since F has no nontrivial finite extensions of odd degree (part (c)) this is a contradiction. Hence, G must be a 2-group.

$\text{Gal}(L/F(\mathbf{i}))$ is a subgroup of the 2-group G , hence is itself a 2-group. If it were nontrivial, every nontrivial $\mathbf{p}$ -group has a subgroup of index $\mathbf{p}$, so $\text{Gal}(L/F(\mathbf{i}))$ would have a subgroup of index 2. By Galois correspondence this yields a degree-2 extension of $F(\mathbf{i})$, contradicting part (d). Hence $\text{Gal}(L/F(\mathbf{i}))$ is trivial, and $F(\mathbf{i})$ is algebraically closed.

- (g) $\mathbb{R}$ and $\overline{\mathbb{Q}} \cap \mathbb{R}$ are real closed fields, and from part (f) we know that $\mathbb{R}(\mathbf{i}) = \mathbb{C}$ and $\overline{\mathbb{Q}} \cap \mathbb{R}(\mathbf{i}) = \overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ are algebraically closed. Hence, $\mathbb{C}$ and $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ are algebraically closed.